

MEMORY HOOK →

G

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U

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A

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R

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D

God-ordained mandate · Undermine aggression · Advance civilization · Ready forces · Doctrine war

OPENING FRAME → START HERE

Peace through strength: government’s first duty is to protect the innocent from real enemies.

GUARD PATH

G

GOD-ORDAINED MANDATE

Romans 13 — the state bears the sword to restrain evil.

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U

UNDERMINE AGGRESSION

Deterrence: weakness invites China, Russia, Iran, NK, and jihadist networks.

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A

ADVANCE CIVILIZATION

America uniquely underwrites liberty, trade, and religious freedom abroad.

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R

READY FORCES

Preparedness: superior military, intel, alliances, energy, and borders.

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D

DOCTRINE WAR

Tyranny is a belief system. Soft power without hard power is begging.

COUNTERS

THEY SAY

“Military spending steals from the poor”

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YOU SAY

Dead citizens can’t be helped. Security enables prosperity — and America’s aid. Both/and (Neh 4).

THEY SAY

“Focus only on domestic issues”

→

YOU SAY

False choice. 9/11 proved distant threats become local catastrophes. Prevention beats aftermath.

THEY SAY

“Diplomacy, not strength”

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YOU SAY

Diplomacy without power is pleading. “Speak softly and carry a big stick.”

THEY SAY

“Christians should be pacifists”

→

YOU SAY

Personal forgiveness ≠ national abdication. Just war tradition: defending the innocent can be righteous.

CLOSE → → Pray and prepare (Prov 21:31). Memory hook: GUARD.